

MagicSchool Choose-Your-Own-Topic Project (K–5)

Three-Session Lesson Packet

(Adapted from teaching_placement lesson packet conventions)

March 26, 2026

Quick Scan

- Grades: K–5 (adaptations included for K–2 and 3–5)
- Sessions: 3 (45–60 minutes each; may be shortened to 30–40 for K–2)
- Core project: student chooses a topic and creates a small “Learning Showcase” product (poster / mini-book / short slide deck)
- AI platform: MagicSchool / MagicStudent (exact tool availability depends on school configuration)
- Key routine: Plan → Build in chunks → Validate and revise

School Planning Goals and Inclusion

- **What is expected:** Students use AI as a learning helper (not a replacement), follow privacy rules, and produce an observable artifact that matches a plan.
- **Inclusion focus:** visual modeling, chunked steps, predictable routines, partner roles, flexible ways to show learning (oral, visual, typed, dictated).
- **Known friction points to guard against:** tool navigation overload, typing/spelling load, and “decorating” before meeting success criteria.
- **Teacher success criteria (visible in the room):** (1) Everyone has a topic + plan, (2) Everyone builds in chunks using the plan, (3) Everyone runs a final check and can explain what they did.

Digital Citizenship and Safe AI Rules (Post as an Anchor Chart)

- **No personal information:** do not type full names, addresses, phone numbers, passwords, or private stories.
- **AI can be wrong:** check important facts using class sources or teacher help.
- **AI is a helper:** you still do the thinking and decide what to use.
- **Be kind and school-appropriate:** prompts must match classroom expectations.
- **Teacher visibility:** remind students that classroom AI work is monitored for safety and learning.

Session Overview Table

Session	Objectives	Activities	Assessment / Evidence
Session 1: Brainstorm Plan	1: Choose topic; generate 3–5 questions/subtopics; create a plan and success checklist.	Mini-lesson + modeling; topic narrowing; complete plan template; teacher approval.	Plan check (topic + questions + steps); exit ticket: “My topic / my 3 questions / next step”.
Session 2: Build in Chunks	Draft section-by-section using plan; verify key facts; begin final product.	Chunked work blocks (Section A/B/C); mid-lesson stop-and-check; partner read-back.	Teacher observation checklist + 1 screenshot/photo of work-in-progress + oral explanation.
Session 3: Revise + Validate	Finalize product; use AI to check structure vs plan; revise and reflect.	AI validation prompt; peer feedback; revise; share; reflect.	Final product + reflection (how AI helped, what I fixed, what I learned).

Session 1: Brainstorm and Lock Topic + High-Level Plan

Teacher materials

Devices; projector; planning template (below); optional topic bins (books, pictures, short texts); sticky notes; timer.

Timing (suggested 50 minutes)

- 0–8 min: Hook + norms (Safe AI Rules)
- 8–18 min: Teacher model: “Bad topic vs good topic” + how to ask AI for ideas safely
- 18–38 min: Student work time: topic choice + plan template
- 38–46 min: Quick conferences: approve topic + plan OR revise
- 46–50 min: Exit ticket + share 1 idea

Teacher notes (step-by-step)

1. **Explain the goal in kid language:** “You will pick something you care about, learn about it, and teach us using a small project. AI can help us think, but we stay in charge.”
2. **Model the first screen/tool move (before release):** Show exactly where students click to enter the student tool you want them to use (e.g., Idea Generator).
3. **Model a safe, age-appropriate prompt:** Use a class example topic. Demonstrate asking for topic ideas plus questions.
4. **Name the success criteria:** Topic + 3–5 questions + product choice + checklist of steps.
5. **Conference for approval:** Students must show the plan before using AI for drafting next session.

Student Plan Template (print or copy into a doc)

- My topic is: _____
- Why I chose it (1 sentence or drawing): _____
- My 3–5 questions / parts:
 1. _____
 2. _____
 3. _____
 4. _____
 5. _____
- My product choice (circle one): Poster Mini-book Slides
- My checklist (what I will finish):
 1. Plan approved
 2. Section 1 drafted
 3. Section 2 drafted
 4. Section 3 drafted
 5. Visuals added
 6. Final check + revise
 7. Share + reflect

Sample student prompts (MagicSchool / AI)

- **K–2 prompt (Idea Generator):** “I am a student. Give me 5 topic ideas about _____ that are easy for kids. For each topic, give 2 questions I could learn about.”
- **3–5 prompt (Idea Generator):** “My interests are _____. Help me choose a focused topic I can teach in 3 sections. Give me 5 options and 4 research questions for each.”
- **Topic narrowing prompt:** “My topic is too big: _____. Help me make it smaller so I can teach it in 3 sections (A, B, C). Give 3 smaller choices.”

Session 2: Learn and Execute Step-by-Step Using the Plan

Teacher materials

Student plans; note-catcher; teacher-provided sources (books/articles/videos pre-approved); creation tool (poster paper, slides, book tool); timer.

Timing (suggested 55 minutes)

- 0–7 min: Re-launch norms + show “Plan → Build in chunks”
- 7–12 min: Model: how to draft *one* section from a plan question
- 12–42 min: Chunked work time (3 chunks of 10 min + quick resets)
- 42–48 min: Midpoint stop-and-check (compare to plan)
- 48–55 min: Save work + quick share (1 fact + how you checked it)

Teacher notes (step-by-step)

1. **Start with the plan:** Students point to their first question/section before opening tools.
2. **Limit tool choice:** Preselect 1–2 student tools for drafting (e.g., Informational Texts OR Research Assistant).
3. **Teach verification simply:** “If AI says a fact, find it in a class book/text or ask the teacher.”
4. **Use a help ladder:** Look at directions → try 1 small step → ask partner → ask teacher 1 clear question.
5. **Midpoint stop-and-check:** Students use a checklist: “I finished section 1/2/3” and name what is missing.

Sample student prompts (MagicSchool / AI)

- **K–2 drafting prompt (Informational Texts / Content Creator):** “Write 5 simple sentences about _____ for kids. Add 3 vocabulary words and explain them in kid words.”
- **3–5 drafting prompt (Informational Texts):** “Write a short informational passage (3 paragraphs) about _____. Organize it into: Section A _____, Section B _____, Section C _____. Use grade _____ words.”
- **Question-by-question prompt (Research Assistant):** “My question is: _____. Give a short answer and 3 key words I can use to check this in a book or class source.”
- **Clarity prompt (Writing Feedback):** “Here is my section. Tell me one thing that is clear and one thing I should fix to make it easier to understand for kids.”

Session 3: Finish Project + AI Validation Against Plan & Lesson Structure

Teacher materials

Rubric; student plans; peer feedback protocol (two stars + one wish); reflection sheet; sharing setup (gallery walk / small presentations).

Timing (suggested 50 minutes)

- 0–6 min: Re-launch: “Today we polish and check our work.”
- 6–18 min: AI validation + structure check vs plan
- 18–35 min: Revision time (fix missing parts, improve clarity, correct errors)
- 35–45 min: Share (gallery walk or mini-presentations)
- 45–50 min: Reflection + submit

Teacher notes (step-by-step)

1. **Teach “AI as checker”:** Explain that AI can help check structure/clarity but cannot be trusted automatically for truth.
2. **Run the validation prompt:** Students paste their plan + their draft into the AI tool (if allowed) and ask for a checklist of missing pieces.
3. **Human verification:** Require students to confirm at least 2 key facts with a classroom source or teacher check.
4. **Celebrate learning:** Students share 1 thing they learned and 1 way they used AI responsibly.

Sample AI validation prompts

- “Here is my plan: (paste plan). Here is my project: (paste text). Make a checklist: What matches? What is missing? What should I fix first?”
- “Does my project have these parts: Title, Section A, Section B, Section C, a picture/visual, and a final reflection sentence? If not, tell me what to add.”
- “Find any sentence that sounds too hard for a _____ grader. Suggest simpler words.”

Assessment

Teacher assessment methods

- **Formative:** plan approval, observation checklist during chunked drafting, midpoint stop-and-check.
- **Summative:** final product + short reflection + responsible AI use.
- **Evidence artifacts:** 1 saved plan, 1 work-in-progress screenshot/photo, final product.

Optional student reflection (collect at end)

- My topic was: _____
- AI helped me by: _____
- I checked my work by: _____
- One thing I fixed after checking: _____
- I am proud of: _____

Official References (Teacher)

- CSTA K–12 CS Standards (Revised 2017): <https://csteachers.org/k12standards/>
- MagicSchool Student Data Policy: <https://www.magicschool.ai/privacy-security/student-data-policy>
- U.S. Department of Education (OET), AI and the Future of Teaching and Learning (2023): <https://www2.ed.gov/documents/ai-report/ai-report.pdf>
- UNESCO Guidance for Generative AI in Education and Research (2023): <https://www.unesco.org/en/articles/guidance-generative-ai-education-and-research>
- CAST UDL Guidelines: <https://udlguidelines.cast.org/>